

Chapter 22

PRISMA — systematic reviews & meta-analyses

PRISMA — *Preferred Reporting Items for Systematic reviews and Meta-Analyses* — covers systematic reviews and meta-analyses. The 27-item checklist and flow diagram are at <https://www.prisma-statement.org/>. The templates below cover pairwise and network meta-analysis methods.

This page contains **25 method-specific templates**. Each is a skeleton with placeholders in italics; the prose is written so you can paste it into a manuscript and replace only the bracketed values.

22.0.1 Bivariate SROC Curves

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Bivariate SROC Curves** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $\alpha = 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Bivariate SROC Curves yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → bivariate-sroc — For Reviewers

22.0.2 Converting Between Effect Sizes

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Converting Between Effect Sizes** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Converting Between Effect Sizes yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → effect-size-conversion — For Reviewers

22.0.3 Cumulative Meta-Analysis

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Cumulative Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Cumulative Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → cumulative-meta-analysis — For Reviewers

22.0.4 Egger's Test for Funnel Asymmetry

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Egger's Test for Funnel Asymmetry** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Egger's Test for Funnel Asymmetry yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `egger-test` — For Reviewers

22.0.5 Fixed-Effect vs. Random-Effects Meta-Analysis

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Fixed-Effect vs. Random-Effects Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Fixed-Effect vs. Random-Effects Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `fixed-vs-random-effects` — For Reviewers

22.0.6 Forest Plots in Meta-Analysis

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Forest Plots in Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Forest Plots in Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `forest-plot-meta` — For Reviewers

22.0.7 Funnel Plots

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Funnel Plots** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were

checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use = 0.05; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Funnel Plots yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `funnel-plot-meta` — For Reviewers

22.0.8 Individual Participant Data Meta-Analysis

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Individual Participant Data Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use = 0.05; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Individual Participant Data Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `ipd-meta-analysis` — For Reviewers

22.0.9 Leave-One-Out Meta-Analysis

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Leave-One-Out Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use = 0.05; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Leave-One-Out Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `leave-one-out` — For Reviewers

22.0.10 Meta-Analysis of Diagnostic Accuracy

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Meta-Analysis of Diagnostic Accuracy** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Meta-Analysis of Diagnostic Accuracy yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → diagnostic-test-meta — For Reviewers

22.0.11 Meta-Regression

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Meta-Regression** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Meta-Regression yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → meta-regression — For Reviewers

22.0.12 Network Meta-Analysis: Introduction

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Network Meta-Analysis: Introduction** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Network Meta-Analysis: Introduction yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → network-meta-analysis-intro
— For Reviewers

22.0.13 NMA Consistency and Inconsistency

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **NMA Consistency and Inconsistency** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p -values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

NMA Consistency and Inconsistency yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → nma-consistency — For Reviewers

22.0.14 NMA League Tables

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **NMA League Tables** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p -values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

NMA League Tables yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → nma-league-tables — For Reviewers

22.0.15 Pooling Correlation Coefficients

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Pooling Correlation Coefficients** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R

[vX.Y]. Assumptions were checked: [list checks performed]. [Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]. Two-sided p-values use = 0.05; [multiple-comparison adjustment if any].

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Pooling Correlation Coefficients yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]. [Sensitivity analysis result].*

Reviewer checklist for this method. → correlation-pooling — For Reviewers

22.0.16 Pooling Log-Odds Ratios

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Pooling Log-Odds Ratios** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]. [Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]. Two-sided p-values use = 0.05; [multiple-comparison adjustment if any].*

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Pooling Log-Odds Ratios yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]. [Sensitivity analysis result].*

Reviewer checklist for this method. → log-odds-ratio-pooling — For Reviewers

22.0.17 Pooling Risk Ratios

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Pooling Risk Ratios** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]. [Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]. Two-sided p-values use = 0.05; [multiple-comparison adjustment if any].*

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Pooling Risk Ratios yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]. [Sensitivity analysis result].*

Reviewer checklist for this method. → risk-ratio-pooling — For Reviewers

22.0.18 Prediction Intervals in Meta-Analysis

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Prediction Intervals in Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Prediction Intervals in Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → prediction-interval-meta — For Reviewers

22.0.19 Quantifying Heterogeneity: Q and I^2

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Quantifying Heterogeneity: Q and I^2** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Quantifying Heterogeneity: Q and I^2 yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → heterogeneity-q-i2 — For Reviewers

22.0.20 Selection Models for Publication Bias

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Selection Models for Publication Bias** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Selection Models for Publication Bias yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → selection-models-bias — For Reviewers

22.0.21 Standardised Mean Difference: Hedges' g**Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):**

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Standardised Mean Difference: Hedges' g** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Standardised Mean Difference: Hedges' g yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → smd-hedges-g — For Reviewers

22.0.22 Subgroup Meta-Analysis**Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):**

[N=] participants/observations were analysed using **Subgroup Meta-Analysis** as implemented in *[package vX.Y]* in R *[vX.Y]*. Assumptions were checked: *[list checks performed]*. *[Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome]*. Two-sided p-values use $= 0.05$; *[multiple-comparison adjustment if any]*.

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Subgroup Meta-Analysis yielded *[estimate]* (95% CI *[lower, upper]*, $p = [value]$). *[Diagnostic / assumption summary]*. *[Sensitivity analysis result]*.

Reviewer checklist for this method. → subgroup-meta-analysis — For Reviewers

22.0.23 SUCRA Rankings**Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):**

[*N*=] participants/observations were analysed using **SUCRA Rankings** as implemented in [*package vX.Y*] in R [*vX.Y*]. Assumptions were checked: [*list checks performed*]. [*Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome*]. Two-sided p-values use $\alpha = 0.05$; [*multiple-comparison adjustment if any*].

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

SUCRA Rankings yielded [*estimate*] (95% CI [*lower, upper*], $p =$ [*value*]). [*Diagnostic / assumption summary*]. [*Sensitivity analysis result*].

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `nma-sucra` — For Reviewers

22.0.24 Tau-Squared Estimation

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[*N*=] participants/observations were analysed using **Tau-Squared Estimation** as implemented in [*package vX.Y*] in R [*vX.Y*]. Assumptions were checked: [*list checks performed*]. [*Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome*]. Two-sided p-values use $\alpha = 0.05$; [*multiple-comparison adjustment if any*].

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Tau-Squared Estimation yielded [*estimate*] (95% CI [*lower, upper*], $p =$ [*value*]). [*Diagnostic / assumption summary*]. [*Sensitivity analysis result*].

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `tau-squared-estimation` — For Reviewers

22.0.25 Trim-and-Fill

Methods paragraph (copy-paste, fill in italics):

[*N*=] participants/observations were analysed using **Trim-and-Fill** as implemented in [*package vX.Y*] in R [*vX.Y*]. Assumptions were checked: [*list checks performed*]. [*Effect size with 95% confidence interval reported as the primary outcome*]. Two-sided p-values use $\alpha = 0.05$; [*multiple-comparison adjustment if any*].

Results paragraph (copy-paste):

Trim-and-Fill yielded [*estimate*] (95% CI [*lower, upper*], $p =$ [*value*]). [*Diagnostic / assumption summary*]. [*Sensitivity analysis result*].

Reviewer checklist for this method. → `trim-and-fill` — For Reviewers